

EASTBOUND GROUP

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# Event Planning Checklist

*From first brief to final arrival*

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Destination Management · Events · Incentives · Conferences

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# Event Planning Checklist

*From first brief to final arrival.*

A practical checklist of the decisions that shape an event, in the order they usually arise. Print it, share it with your team and tick items off as you go.

## A NOTE ON TIMING

The timings shown are guidance only. Large groups, peak seasons, and destinations with limited flights or rooms (such as Bhutan) need longer lead times.

### 1. THE BRIEF Start here

- ☐ Objectives agreed: what should this event achieve?
- ☐ Audience defined: who is attending, and what do they value?
- ☐ Group size estimated, with a realistic range
- ☐ Budget range confirmed, including what is and is not included
- ☐ Preferred dates and flexibility on dates established
- ☐ Decision makers and approval process identified

### 2. DESTINATION AND VENUE 9 to 12 months out

- ☐ Destinations compared against objectives, season and group profile
- ☐ Venue shortlist prepared and requirements matched
- ☐ Site inspection arranged, in person or virtual
- ☐ Availability, holds and options confirmed in writing
- ☐ Contracts reviewed: capacity, cancellation, payment schedule

### 3. TRAVEL AND ACCOMMODATION 6 to 9 months out

- ☐ Room block agreed with cut-off and attrition terms
- ☐ International flights and airport arrival plan considered
- ☐ Domestic flights and ground transport planned
- ☐ Special requirements noted: accessibility, dietary, VIP handling
- ☐ Extension and pre- or post-event stays offered, if relevant

### 4. PROGRAMME DESIGN 4 to 6 months out

- ☐ Agenda drafted, with pacing and free time built in
- ☐ Signature experiences and gala evening chosen
- ☐ Speakers, hosts, entertainers and guides confirmed
- ☐ Dining and catering planned, including dietary and cultural needs
- ☐ Weather and contingency options prepared for each outdoor moment
- ☐ Branding, staging, AV and production needs specified

**5. COMPLIANCE AND LOGISTICS** 3 to 6 months out

- ☐ Visa and entry requirements checked for every nationality in the group
- ☐ Permits and local approvals arranged where needed
- ☐ Insurance reviewed: event, cancellation and traveller cover
- ☐ Health and safety requirements and local regulations checked
- ☐ Payment schedule and supplier deposits tracked

**6. GUEST EXPERIENCE AND COMMUNICATIONS** 1 to 3 months out

- ☐ Invitations and registration open, with a clear response deadline
- ☐ Guest information pack sent: dress, weather, etiquette, what to bring
- ☐ Guest list, rooming list and dietary details finalised
- ☐ Welcome plan prepared: airport greeters, signage, arrival gifts
- ☐ On-ground team and emergency contacts briefed
- ☐ Contingency plan agreed for delays, weather and last-minute changes

**7. FINAL ARRIVAL** Final two weeks and event days

- ☐ Final numbers confirmed with all suppliers
- ☐ Run sheets, transport manifests and timelines circulated
- ☐ Briefing held with the full on-ground team
- ☐ Flight arrivals monitored and transfers adjusted
- ☐ Daily check-in with the client and key suppliers

**8. AFTER THE EVENT** Within 4 weeks

- ☐ Guest feedback collected
- ☐ Supplier reconciliation and final payments completed
- ☐ Photos and content shared with guests
- ☐ Learnings recorded for the next event

**WANT HELP WORKING THROUGH IT?**

Our team can turn this checklist into a live plan for your event. Email [info@eastboundgroup.com](mailto:info@eastboundgroup.com)